

RENEWED REST · DIGITAL GUIDE

# Sleep Skill Building: *A Complete Parent's Guide*

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Ages 3-18 Months

Printable Sleep Log Included

## A NOTE FROM EMILY

If you're reading this, you're probably exhausted. Maybe you've been up three, four, five times a night. Maybe your baby has never slept more than two hours in a row. Maybe bedtime has become the hardest part of your day — and you've started to wonder if something is wrong with you, or your baby, or both.

Nothing is wrong with you. Nothing is wrong with your baby. Sleep is a skill — and like every skill, it has to be learned. That's what this guide is about: not "training" your baby in the way a coach trains an athlete, but building something together. Patiently. With your baby.

I'm Emily. I'm an IPSP® certified sleep consultant, and I'm a mother of five. I have sat in the same exhausted fog you're sitting in. I have paced the hallway at 2 a.m. more times than I can count. And I have seen, over and over again — with my own children and with the many families I've had the privilege of walking alongside — that sleep can get better. It will get better. This guide is my way of walking alongside you while it does.

— *Emily*

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## What Sleep Skill Building Really Means

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*Sleep is not something that happens to your baby. It's something your baby learns to do — and you can help.*

When most people hear the phrase "sleep training," they picture a baby crying alone in a dark room while a parent sits outside counting minutes on the clock, trying not to go in. That image — whatever shaped it — is not what we're talking about here.

Sleep Skill Building is exactly what it sounds like. Your baby is learning a skill. Just like learning to roll over, to pull up to stand, to wave goodbye, or to hold a spoon — sleep is a developmental milestone that babies practice and get better at over time. It doesn't come automatically for every baby. Some need more support to find it than others. And that's okay.

### Why Some Babies Struggle to Sleep

Newborns sleep in short, fragmented cycles — and that's completely normal. Their sleep cycles are shorter than ours (roughly 40–50 minutes), they spend more time in light sleep, and they naturally rouse between cycles. In the earliest weeks, most babies cannot link sleep cycles independently — they wake up between cycles and need help getting back down.

As babies grow, they become *capable* of linking cycles on their own. The question is whether they've had the opportunity to practice. Many babies — especially those who are rocked, nursed, or held to sleep every time — never develop the chance to figure out how to settle themselves. When they wake between sleep cycles (which they will, every single night, multiple times), they don't know how to go back to sleep without the same conditions they fell asleep in. So they cry. And the cycle continues.

#### KEY IDEA

Babies who wake frequently at night are not broken. They are doing exactly what they were designed to do — they're just still relying on external help to get back to sleep. Sleep Skill Building is the process of gently shifting that responsibility.

### What "Independent Sleep" Actually Means

Independent sleep does not mean your baby sleeps alone without comfort or connection. It means your baby has the ability to fall asleep on their own — and go back to sleep on their own when they wake between sleep cycles — without needing you to be physically present or actively doing something to make it happen.

The goal is not a baby who never needs you. The goal is a baby who can settle themselves — so that the nights that do require you are genuine needs, not habit-driven waking.

### What This Approach Is Not

- It is not "letting your baby cry it out" indefinitely. This guide uses the Quick Check method, which keeps you actively involved throughout the process.
- It is not a rigid, one-size-fits-all program. Your baby is unique. This guide gives you a framework — not a script.
- It is not harmful. Decades of research consistently show that sleep training methods — including those involving some crying — do not cause lasting emotional harm to babies.
- It is not a betrayal of your instincts or your bond. Teaching your baby to sleep is one of the most loving, lasting gifts you can give them.

*"The goal isn't to stop responding to your baby. It's to respond to their real needs — not just their learned ones."*

## A Word on Readiness

Most babies are developmentally ready to begin building sleep skills between 3–4 months of age (adjusted age for premature babies). Before that window, the focus should be on establishing healthy sleep foundations rather than independent sleep. If your baby is younger than 3 months, Chapter 4 — Healthy Sleep Habits — is a great place to focus your energy right now.

If your baby is older than 18 months, the principles here still apply, but the behavioral piece becomes more complex. A 1:1 consultation may serve you better at that stage. Reach out anytime — I'm happy to help.

### CHAPTER TWO

## Wake Windows: The Secret to Timing Sleep Right

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*More than almost anything else, timing determines whether your baby's sleep attempt will succeed or struggle.*

A wake window is the period of time your baby can comfortably stay awake between sleeps. Every baby has a biological window of opportunity — a stretch of time after which they are ready to sleep again. Put a baby down before that window closes and they're not tired enough to settle. Wait too long past that window and they become overtired — and overtired babies paradoxically fight sleep the hardest.

Getting wake windows right is one of the most impactful things you can do for your baby's sleep — and it costs nothing.

# Wake Windows by Age

These windows are averages. Your baby may run slightly shorter or longer — that's normal. Watch your baby's sleepy cues alongside the clock, and you'll find the sweet spot.

| AGE          | WAKE TIME LENGTH | NAPS     | MAX DAY SLEEP | TOTAL SLEEP (NAPS + NIGHT) |
|--------------|------------------|----------|---------------|----------------------------|
| 1 Month      | 1 Hour           | 4+ Naps  | 5-6 Hours     | 14-17 Hours                |
| 2 Months     | 1.25 Hours       | 4+ Naps  | 5 Hours       | 14-17 Hours                |
| 3 Months     | 1.5 Hours        | 4 Naps   | 4 Hours       | 14-17 Hours                |
| 4 Months     | 2 Hours          | 3-4 Naps | 4 Hours       | 12-15 Hours                |
| 5 Months     | 2.25 Hours       | 3 Naps   | 3.5-4 Hours   | 12-15 Hours                |
| 6 Months     | 2.5 Hours        | 2-3 Naps | 3.5 Hours     | 12-15 Hours                |
| 7 Months     | 2.75 Hours       | 2-3 Naps | 3-3.5 Hours   | 12-15 Hours                |
| 8 Months     | 3 Hours          | 2-3 Naps | 3 Hours       | 12-15 Hours                |
| 9 Months     | 3-3.5 Hours      | 2 Naps   | 3 Hours       | 12-15 Hours                |
| 10 Months    | 3.5-4 Hours      | 2 Naps   | 2.5 Hours     | 12-15 Hours                |
| 11 Months    | 4-5 Hours        | 1-2 Naps | 2.5-3 Hours   | 12-15 Hours                |
| 12-18 Months | 4-5 Hours        | 2 Naps   | 2 Hours       | 11-14 Hours                |
| 12-18 Months | 4.5-6 Hours      | 1 Nap    | 3 Hours       | 11-14 Hours                |
| 18 Months    | 5-7 Hours        | 1 Nap    | 3 Hours       | 11-14 Hours                |
| 22 Mos-3 Yrs | 5-7 Hours        | 1 Nap    | 2-3 Hours     | 11-14 Hours                |

*(Average 2.5 Yrs) — Might need less day sleep or may be ready to drop the nap completely.*

## Sleepy Cues: What to Watch For

The clock is a guide — your baby's behavior is the real signal. These cues tell you your baby is approaching the end of their wake window:

- ✓ Yawning (one or two yawns is a strong signal; frantic repeated yawning may mean you've waited too long)
- ✓ Eye rubbing or pulling at ears
- ✓ Glazed, unfocused eyes or staring into the distance
- ✓ Slowing down or losing interest in play
- ✓ Reduced smiling or social engagement
- ✓ Fussiness that seems to appear "out of nowhere"

### WATCH OUT FOR

**The second wind.** If you miss the initial sleepy window, your baby may get a burst of renewed energy — a "second wind." This is not a sign they aren't tired. It's a sign their body has released cortisol to compensate. A baby in second wind will have a much harder time falling asleep and staying asleep. When in doubt, err on the side of an earlier bedtime.

## The Last Wake Window of the Day

The wake window before bedtime is usually the most important and the longest. As your baby gets older, that final window stretches significantly. A common mistake is putting babies to bed too early in the evening — especially after a late afternoon nap. If bedtime is a battle every single night, check whether the last wake window is long enough.

As a general rule: bedtime is almost always more successful between 7:00 and 8:00 PM for babies over 4 months, following a full wake window from the last nap of the day.



# Sleep Props: What They Are and What to Do About Them

*A sleep prop isn't a villain. It's just something that has become necessary — and understanding that is the first step to gently changing it.*

A sleep prop is any external condition that your baby requires to fall asleep and that they cannot reproduce on their own during the night. When your baby wakes between sleep cycles — which happens multiple times every night — they look for the same conditions that were present when they first fell asleep. If those conditions are missing, they cry for help restoring them.

## Common Sleep Props

|                                           |                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nursing or bottle-feeding to sleep</b> | One of the most powerful and common sleep associations. Your baby genuinely falls asleep while eating, and their brain learns that eating = sleeping.            |
| <b>Rocking, bouncing, or motion</b>       | Babies love motion. Car rides, stroller walks, and bouncing on a yoga ball are remarkably effective at inducing sleep — which means they can become relied upon. |
| <b>Being held</b>                         | Contact naps and falling asleep in a parent's arms are beautiful. They become a prop when they're the only way a baby can fall asleep.                           |
| <b>Pacifier</b>                           | A pacifier is a passive prop: your baby can't put it back in their mouth independently, so when it falls out mid-sleep, they wake and cry for you to replace it. |

### IMPORTANT

None of these things are wrong or harmful to your baby. They are responses to your baby's needs, and many of them are genuinely beautiful parts of early parenthood. This is not about guilt. It's about choice — and understanding which props are making nights harder than they need to be.

## How to Tell if a Prop Is a Problem

Ask yourself this question: *If this condition disappears at 2 AM, will my baby wake up and cry?*

If the answer is yes — that's a prop that's likely driving night waking. The goal of sleep skill building is to help your baby fall asleep without conditions they can't recreate independently, so that when they wake naturally between sleep cycles, they can settle back down on their own.

## Adjusting Sleep Props Gently

You don't have to eliminate props abruptly. Gradual fading is a valid approach for many families:

- 1 Ending the nursing feed before baby falls asleep.** Instead of nursing until your baby is completely out, nurse until they are calm and showing signs of sleepiness — but their eyes are still open and they are still aware. "Drowsy" does not mean eyes are closing; that is actually the first stage of sleep, and that window has passed. You are looking for a baby who is relaxed, milk-drunk, and clearly ready for sleep — but still awake and present. Put them down in that state and let them finish the job on their own. Over several days, you can gradually end the feed a little earlier each time.
- 2 Ending the rocking session before baby falls asleep.** Same principle. Rock until they are calm, settled, and ready for sleep — eyes open, body relaxed. Lay them down while they still have awareness of the transition. If their eyes are closing or closing and reopening heavily, you have gone a little too long.

- 3 Chair method for props.** If you've been holding your baby to sleep, start the process of sitting nearby while they fall asleep, then gradually increase the distance each night until you're outside the room.
- 4 Pacifier management.** For babies over 6 months who have motor control, practice placing the pacifier in their hand during the day so they can begin to associate it with finding it themselves. Many families find that moving the pacifier toward the "lovey" stage — where it becomes a comfort object they can locate — reduces the dependency significantly.

#### GOOD TO KNOW

Whatever approach you take, consistency matters more than speed. Gradual fading works — but it requires you to follow through with the same approach every single sleep for at least 1–2 weeks. Inconsistency teaches your baby that escalating protest will eventually bring the prop back.

## CHAPTER FOUR

# Healthy Sleep Habits for Parents

*Before any method, before any technique, the foundation you build matters most. And much of it is in your hands.*

The environment you create, the routines you establish, and the responses you give shape your baby's sleep more than any single approach. These habits don't require anything dramatic — most are simple, free, and can begin tonight.

## 1. Build a Consistent Bedtime Routine

A predictable sequence of events before sleep is one of the most evidence-backed tools available to parents. A good bedtime routine signals your baby's brain that sleep is coming — and gives them a sense of security and calm before the transition.

An effective routine is 20–40 minutes long and includes 3–5 consistent steps in the same order, every night. It might look like:

- ✓ Feed — always at the beginning of the routine, not the end. This separates eating from falling asleep and is one of the most important habit shifts you can make.
- ✓ Massage or lotion — slow, calm, loving touch
- ✓ Clean diaper and sleep sack or pajamas
- ✓ One or two books, a sung song, or quiet connection time
- ✓ Into the crib, with a brief, consistent phrase: "I love you. It's time to sleep. Goodnight."

#### WHY FEED FIRST

Feeding at the beginning of the routine — rather than right before sleep — breaks the feed-to-sleep association. When the last thing your baby experiences before the crib is a book or a song instead of nursing or a bottle, they learn to fall asleep without food as the trigger. This single shift makes an enormous difference over time, even before any other changes are made.

## 2. Create an Optimal Sleep Environment

Your baby's sleep space should be a cue for rest. These are the elements that matter most:

- ✓ **Darkness.** As dark as you can make it. Blackout curtains are one of the best investments you can make. Light signals the brain to stay awake — and early morning light is a primary driver of early rising.
- ✓ **White noise.** A continuous, consistent sound machine set at around 65–70 dB (roughly the level of a shower running). It masks household sounds, extends naps, and becomes a powerful sleep cue. Keep it running all night and through naps.
- ✓ **Cool temperature.** The ideal sleep temperature for babies is between 68–72°F. Overheating is associated with disrupted sleep and is a safety risk.
- ✓ **Safe sleep space.** Firm, flat mattress. Nothing in the crib. Always on their back until they can roll independently. Follow your pediatrician's current safe sleep guidelines.

### **3. Watch Your Own Response Patterns**

This is the one parents often don't expect to hear — but it's important. The speed and consistency of your response to your baby's nighttime sounds shapes what your baby learns about sleep.

Rushing in at the first sound — before your baby is even fully awake — can interrupt a natural sleep cycle transition that your baby might have resolved on their own in 30-60 seconds. A brief pause to observe — not to ignore, but to assess — can make a meaningful difference.

This isn't about being less loving. It's about giving your baby a moment to find their way, before assuming they need you to do it for them.

### **4. Protect Naps — But Don't Over-Engineer Them**

Naps and night sleep are deeply connected. Chronically undertired or overtired babies sleep worse at night. A good nap schedule — appropriate to your baby's age and wake windows — supports better nighttime sleep.

That said, naps at this age are often unpredictable, and that's okay. Focus on the nap schedule as a guide, not a rigid rule. The most important nap is the first one of the day — getting that one right tends to stabilize the rest of the day.

### **5. Build Your Own Consistency and Confidence**

Your baby reads you. Your nervousness, your hesitation, your inconsistency — they pick up on all of it. One of the most powerful things you can do is commit to a plan, follow through with it, and project calm confidence even on the hard nights.

It gets harder before it gets easier. Night two and three of any new approach are almost always more difficult than night one. That is not a sign the approach isn't working. It is a predictable pattern of change. Hold steady.

## The Quick Check Method, Step by Step

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*The Quick Check method keeps you in the picture. Your baby is never alone in the dark, and you are never in the dark about how they're doing.*

Quick Checks are timed, structured check-ins during periods when your baby is crying and working on settling. The premise is simple: you give your baby a window of time to practice settling on their own — but at regular intervals, you go in to let them know you're there. You offer a small amount of comfort, then step back out and give them another opportunity to settle.

This approach balances two things your baby needs simultaneously: *space to practice* and *the security of knowing you're close*.

### Why Quick Checks Work

When a baby is learning to settle, they are not suffering — they are working. The crying is communication: *I don't know how to do this yet, and I want help*. Quick Checks acknowledge that communication without taking over the task entirely. You come in, you say: *I hear you. I'm here. I love you*. And then you give them the space to finish the work themselves.

Over several nights, your baby builds the neurological pathways to settle — and the checks become shorter and less frequent because they need them less.

### Before You Begin: The Setup

- ✓ Your baby is fed, changed, and has gone through their full bedtime routine.
- ✓ You have put your baby down in their crib ready for sleep but with eyes wide open. "Drowsy" in this context means your baby is relaxed, calm, and clearly tired — not that their eyes are heavy or closing. Eyes starting to close means your baby is already entering the first stage of sleep and the independent settling window has been missed. You are looking for a baby who is ready but still awake and present.

- ✓ The room is dark and the environment is set for sleep.
- ✓ You have decided in advance which interval option you will use for the night.

## The Interval Schedule

There are two options for structuring your checks. Choose the one that feels right for your family and stick with it consistently.

### OPTION 1 — CONSISTENT TIMER

Set a single timer for **10 minutes** and use that same interval every time, every check, every night. Simple, predictable, and easy to follow when you're exhausted. Many families do best with this approach because there is no decision-making in the moment.

### OPTION 2 — GRADUATED INTERVALS

Begin with shorter intervals and gradually increase them over the course of a night and across nights. This can ease you and your baby into the process more gently.

| CHECK NUMBER | NIGHT 1-2 (MIN)   | NIGHT 3+ (MIN)    |
|--------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Check 1      | 5 minutes         | 7 minutes         |
| Check 2      | 8 minutes         | 10 minutes        |
| Check 3      | 10 minutes        | 12 minutes        |
| Check 4+     | 10 minutes (hold) | 15 minutes (hold) |

### HOW TO TIME THE INTERVALS

**Timers start when your baby starts crying** — not when you leave the room. If your baby stops crying before the timer goes off, that is self-soothing — a success. Stop the timer. If they start crying again, start a fresh timer from the beginning. The only exception is if your baby has significant separation anxiety; in that case, starting the timer from when you exit the room may feel more manageable for both of you.

## What to Do During a Quick Check

|                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Enter calmly</b>            | Walk in without turning on the lights. Speak in a quiet, reassuring voice before you reach the crib: "I'm here. You're okay."                                                                                                               |
| <b>2. Keep it brief</b>           | 60 seconds or less. The check is reassurance, not a sleep aid. Going in for longer can increase frustration and reset the settling process.                                                                                                 |
| <b>3. Voice and gentle touch</b>  | Pat their chest or back, use your words. "You're safe. Mama loves you. It's time to sleep." Short, calm, consistent.                                                                                                                        |
| <b>4. Do not pick up</b>          | Unless there is a genuine need — illness, diaper, vomiting. Picking up resets the settling process and can prolong the learning curve significantly.                                                                                        |
| <b>5. Leave while still awake</b> | It can feel counterintuitive to leave when they're still upset — but that's the point. They need the opportunity to finish settling on their own. You've checked in, offered comfort, and confirmed they're safe and loved. That is enough. |



### FOR YOU, NOT JUST FOR BABY

Quick Checks are partly for your baby's reassurance — and partly for yours. Knowing you will go in gives you something to hold onto during the hard minutes. You don't have to listen and do nothing. You're on a schedule. You're in control of this process. That reframe makes an enormous difference for parents who struggled with other approaches.

## What to Expect Night by Night

- ✓ **Night 1:** Often the longest night. Some babies take 45–90 minutes to fall asleep. This is normal. Do not abandon the plan on night one.
- ✓ **Night 2–3:** Frequently the hardest. Babies often protest more on night 2 and 3 before things improve — this is called an "extinction burst" and is a predictable pattern of any learned behavior change. Hold the line.
- ✓ **Night 4–5:** Most families see meaningful improvement here. Settling time shortens, checks become less necessary.
- ✓ **Night 6–7:** Many babies are falling asleep within 5–20 minutes by this point. Night wakings are reducing or gone.

## Night Wakings: Applying Quick Checks After Bedtime

When your baby wakes after an initial period of sleep, the same approach applies. First, give your baby a brief pause — 3–5 minutes of observation — to see if they can resettle on their own before you begin the check schedule. Many babies at this stage will resettle within a few minutes if given the chance.

If they don't resettle on their own, begin your interval checks using whichever option you have chosen.

#### WHEN TO FEED AT NIGHT

Babies 3 months and younger typically need multiple feeds throughout the night — this is completely developmentally appropriate and those feeds should always be honored. After 3–4 months, many babies no longer require nighttime feeds, though every baby is different. If your baby is experiencing any weight concerns, a nighttime feed is often still very much needed regardless of age. Parents and pediatricians know their child best — always talk to your pediatrician to decide what is right for your baby. A comfort vs. hunger chart is included in this guide to help you read your baby's nighttime cues.

### Hunger or Comfort?

The most common question from parents is: *"How do I know if my baby is really hungry or not?"* The chart below will help guide you. On the left are signs that your baby may be waking due to hunger. On the right are clues that your baby is most likely using a feeding for comfort to go back to sleep. These are not definite signs, and every baby is different — however, these cues have been accurate for the majority of the babies I have worked with.

|  <b>Hunger</b>                                                                        |  <b>Comfort</b>                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Your baby falls back asleep after a feeding, completely on his/her own, and after being laid down wide awake.                                                            | Your baby continues to cry after a feeding or requires much more comforting to fall back asleep.                                                      |
| Your baby eats a large amount, remains awake during the feeding, and falls asleep knowing he/she has left your arms and you have left the room.                          | Your baby only suckles a little and falls right back asleep. Sometimes cries immediately when you lay him/her down and wants to suckle a little more. |
| Your baby wants to feed after a very long stretch. The length of this sleep stretch is usually described by parents as "the longest my baby has ever slept."             | Your baby wants to feed frequently (i.e. every couple of hours).                                                                                      |
| Your baby only requires one feeding during the night, and it's usually not until the morning hours. Baby also falls back asleep after feeding completely on his/her own. | Your baby requires many feedings and has to be asleep when laid back down.                                                                            |

## When Not to Do Quick Checks

- When your baby is ill. Rest, comfort, and extra parental presence are appropriate during illness — and it is okay to pause the process. That said, try your best to maintain your good sleep habits even during sick days. Bad habits are very commonly created during illness and teething because it is so hard to hear a sick baby cry. But if you do not want to rock your baby to sleep, co-sleep, or introduce other props you have been working to move away from, try not to start them now. A little extra comfort and presence can be offered in ways that don't create new sleep dependencies.
- During sleep regressions tied to major developmental leaps — if your baby has been sleeping well and suddenly regresses, give it a week of extra support before returning to the plan. It is worth noting that many babies who have built strong sleep skills handle regressions significantly better than those who haven't. Good sleep habits built ahead of time are your best defense against regressions derailing things for long.
- If your baby is not developmentally ready. Talk to your pediatrician if you have concerns about readiness.

### CHAPTER SIX

## Your 7-Day Sleep Skill Building Plan

*Everything in one place. A day-by-day framework to bring it all together with clarity and confidence.*

Before you begin Day 1, spend a day or two in "prep mode." Review the wake window chart for your baby's age, identify the sleep props you'll be adjusting, and confirm your sleep environment is optimized. The more prepared you are before night one, the better equipped you'll be to follow through.

### BEFORE YOU START

Choose a stretch of 7–10 days where you don't have major travel, illness recovery, or disruptions scheduled. You don't need perfect conditions — but having some stability around the plan gives it the best chance of success.

**DAY 1-2***ENVIRONMENT + ROUTINE, OPTIMIZED*

**Daytime:** Implement wake windows for your baby's age. Track awake times, watch for sleepy cues, and practice putting your baby down ready for sleep but with eyes still open for at least one nap — even if it doesn't result in independent sleep yet. The practice matters.

**Bedtime:** Run a full, calm, consistent bedtime routine ending with your baby going into the crib awake (or at least partially awake). Begin the Quick Check schedule at your chosen starting intervals. Log what happens — time asleep, number of checks, total settling time.

**Night wakings:** Pause 3-5 minutes before intervening. If they don't resettle, use your check schedule. Honor any genuine night feeds.

**DAY 3-4***HOLD STEADY THROUGH THE HARD PART*

**Expect more protest.** Days 2-3 are often the hardest — this is the predictable extinction burst. Do not change your approach mid-stream. Staying consistent is the most important thing you can do right now.

**Daytime:** Continue wake windows. Aim to offer at least one nap in the crib at an appropriate time. If naps remain difficult, prioritize getting the night right first — naps usually follow.

**Bedtime:** Hold steady with the interval schedule you have chosen. Many families find the checks become shorter and less frequent even on these harder nights.

**You:** Take care of yourself. Have a partner, friend, or family member on standby if you need it. Remember: this is temporary. The difficulty of this period is a sign that change is happening.

**Most families notice meaningful improvement by night 4 or 5.** Settling time shortens. The number of checks needed at bedtime decreases. Night wakings reduce in frequency or duration.

**Daytime:** If naps are still a struggle, this is a good time to apply the check method to the first nap of the day. Give the nap a 45-minute window — if your baby doesn't fall asleep within that window, try again at the next appropriate wake window and keep the day moving.

**Bedtime:** Continue your interval schedule. It's okay to extend intervals further as your baby shows they can handle longer windows between checks.

**By night 7, many babies are falling asleep independently within 5-25 minutes.**

Many families see zero or one night wake by this point, with the baby resettling quickly or on their own. If your baby is not there yet, that is okay — some babies simply need more time to adjust, and that is completely normal. It may also be worth revisiting your wake windows and daily schedule to make sure the timing is working in your favor. Progress is not always linear, and a few extra days of consistency almost always brings things together.

**Continue your routine without variation.** Consistency is what makes this permanent. The routine, the environment, the approach — keep it all in place.

**Naps:** If you haven't started the check method for naps, now is a natural time to try. Naps respond more slowly than bedtime — expect another week of improvement before naps are consistent.

**Celebrate.** Seriously. What you've done this week is not small. You've given your baby one of the most foundational life skills they'll ever have. You did that. Together.

*"Every night you stayed consistent, you were saying something to your baby: I believe in you. I trust you. I know you can do this. And they heard you."*

APPENDIX

## Printable Sleep Log

Use this log to track your baby's sleep during the 7-day plan. Patterns become visible quickly when you write them down — and watching the numbers improve is one of the most motivating parts of the process.

### Weekly Sleep Tracker

Baby's name: \_\_\_\_\_ Age: \_\_\_\_\_

| DAY   | BEDTIME | # OF CHECKS | SETTLE TIME | NIGHT WAKES |
|-------|---------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| Day 1 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 2 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 3 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 4 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 5 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 6 |         |             |             |             |
| Day 7 |         |             |             |             |

Nap log — track nap start time, method used, and duration each day. Look for patterns: which wake windows led to the best naps? Which nap durations correlated with better nights?

| Daily Nap Tracker |                          | Note wake window lengths and any observations |                          |                          |
|-------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| DAY               | NAP 1<br>time / duration | NAP 2<br>time / duration                      | NAP 3<br>time / duration | NAP 4<br>time / duration |
| Day 1             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 2             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 3             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 4             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 5             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 6             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |
| Day 7             |                          |                                               |                          |                          |

*A note before you close this guide:*

Sleep Skill Building is not a linear process. There will be nights that feel like a setback. Growth spurts, teething, travel, illness — life will interrupt the plan. That's okay. You can always return to it. The skills your baby is building don't disappear. They may need refreshing, but the foundation is there.

If you're struggling — if the plan doesn't seem to be working, if something feels off, if you just need someone in your corner — please reach out. My 1:1 packages are built for exactly this, and I'd love to work alongside you. Your \$27 applies as a credit toward any services booked within the first year of purchase.

You are doing an incredible thing for your family. Keep going.

**Emily Sweetman**

[www.renewed.rest](http://www.renewed.rest)